

[PUBLIC]

API Versioning Policy — NovaTech Platform Engineering

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This policy defines how NovaTech versions its public and internal REST APIs. It mandates URL-path versioning (`/v1/`, `/v2/`), deprecation timelines, and sunset header usage. Non-compliance blocks production deploys via the CI/CD pipeline policy gate introduced in February 2026.

1. Versioning Scheme

NovaTech uses URI versioning: `/api/v{MAJOR}/`. Minor, backward-compatible changes are deployed without a version bump. Breaking changes (removed fields, changed semantics, new required parameters) require a new MAJOR version.

- **v1:** GA as of 2024-09-01. Supported until 2027-09-01 (3-year minimum lifecycle).
- **v2:** GA as of 2026-01-15. Introduces async streaming responses and pagination cursors.
- **v3:** In development under Project Atlas; targets GA in Q4 2026.

2. Deprecation Process

Deprecated endpoints must emit a **Deprecation** header (RFC 8594) and a **Sunset** header 180 days before removal. The API changelog at `/changelog` must be updated within 24 hours of deprecation announcement.

Deprecation Stage	Action Required	Timeline
Announced	Deprecation + Sunset headers set	D+0
Warning	Weekly email to registered consumers	D+90
Critical	Daily email + Slack #api-deprecations	D+150
Sunset	Endpoint removed, returns 410 Gone	D+180

3. Contract Testing

Every API version change triggers a Pact contract test suite in CI. Consumers publish their Pact files to the NovaTech Pact Broker; providers verify against all registered consumer contracts before merging. Failures

block the merge queue.